

From Conflict to Collaboration: Aligning Revenue Teams

By Jason Rigolli — Founder, Revved for Growth · <https://fixyourrevenueengine.com/insights/revenue-team-alignment/>

TL;DR. Sales, marketing, and customer success fight when their incentives, definitions, and hand-offs are unaligned. Real alignment is structural, not cultural. Shared revenue targets, one definition of a qualified lead, documented hand-off SLAs, and a single source of truth in the CRM.

In today's business world, there is a noticeable trend of increasing tension and finger-pointing between Sales, Marketing, and Customer Success teams. This friction is not only counterproductive but also detrimental to a company's growth and customer satisfaction. Let's delve into the existence of this trend, its causes, and potential solutions.

Verifying the Trend

Recent studies and industry reports confirm the growing discord between these departments. For example, a HubSpot report highlights that only 23.1% of sales professionals believe their teams are strongly aligned with marketing, and 52.2% identify misalignment as a significant contributor to lost sales and revenue. Moreover, LinkedIn's research shows that 90% of sales and marketing professionals point to disconnects across strategy, process, content, and culture, impacting overall business performance.

Causes of the Trend

Several factors contribute to the increasing tension and finger-pointing among Sales, Marketing, and Customer Success teams:

1. Misaligned Goals and KPIs

Sales, Marketing, and Customer Success often operate under different objectives and key performance indicators (KPIs). Sales teams are typically focused on short-term revenue targets, Marketing on lead generation and brand awareness, and Customer Success on long-

term customer satisfaction and retention. These differing priorities can lead to conflicts, especially when success in one area appears to undermine another.

2. Communication Breakdown

Ineffective communication channels exacerbate misunderstandings. When teams do not regularly share insights and feedback, assumptions and misconceptions can flourish, leading to finger-pointing when problems arise.

3. Resource and Budget Constraints

Competition for limited resources and budget allocations can foster a sense of competition rather than collaboration. Each team may feel they need to justify their value over others, which can lead to conflict.

4. Cultural Silos

Organizational silos prevent effective collaboration. When teams are isolated from each other. They develop their own cultures and ways of working that may not align with other departments, leading to friction.

Solutions to Alleviate Tension

To mitigate these issues, companies can adopt several strategies to foster better collaboration and alignment:

1. Establish Shared Goals and Metrics

Creating a unified set of objectives that all teams can work towards is crucial. Implementing a service level agreement (SLA) between sales and marketing can help define shared metrics and expectations. This alignment ensures that both teams are accountable for contributing to the overall business goals.

2. Enhance Communication and Collaboration

Regular interdepartmental meetings and collaborative platforms can bridge the communication gap. For instance, having marketing teams attend sales meetings to understand their challenges and vice versa can foster mutual understanding and cooperation.

3. Leverage Integrated Tools and Data

Utilizing integrated CRM systems that provide a holistic view of customer interactions across sales, marketing, and customer success can streamline data sharing and reporting. This integration helps ensure all teams have access to consistent and accurate data, reducing conflicts over metrics.

4. Cultivating a Collaborative Culture

Companies should foster a culture of collaboration built on trust, support, and recognizing each team member's unique skill set and background. This involves directing team members to respective subject matter experts (SMEs) for support, encouraging appreciation for diverse strengths, and leveraging the collective expertise within the team to complement each other seamlessly.

"Encouraging and expressing appreciation for everyone's distinctive strengths fosters this behavior. This approach allows us to leverage the diverse expertise within our team, ensuring that everyone's strengths complement each other seamlessly. Rather than diving into unfamiliar territories. We respect and trust each other's roles, knowing that each individual brings valuable insights and capabilities to the table."

Directing team members to respective subject matter experts (SMEs) for support ensures that each individual's expertise is leveraged effectively, fostering a sense of unity and common purpose.

By embracing these strategies, companies can transform interdepartmental tension into a powerful engine for growth and customer satisfaction. Building a collaborative culture can lead to greater success and fulfillment in organizational endeavors.

References

- "10 Tried-and-True Tips for Sales and Marketing Alignment", HubSpot Blog
- "31 Stats That Prove the Power of Sales and Marketing Alignment", HubSpot Blog
- "Sales-Marketing Alignment Increases Revenue by 208%", HubSpot Blog

Frequently asked

Why do sales and marketing always fight?

Because they're measured on different things. Marketing on lead volume, sales on closed revenue. Until both teams share a revenue number, the friction is built into the org chart.

How do you align sales, marketing, and customer success?

Three structural moves. One shared revenue target. One definition of a qualified opportunity. One hand-off process with SLAs and accountability. Skip these and culture-building won't save you.

Should customer success report to the CRO?

Yes, in any business where expansion and retention drive a meaningful share of revenue. CS reporting to product or operations creates a structural disconnect between acquiring and keeping customers.

[← All insights](#)



About the author — Jason Rigolli

Founder, Revved for Growth · Fractional CRO

Jason Rigolli fixes the reason a company isn't hitting its number. A two-time co-founder with three CRO seats and over two decades rebuilding revenue engines, he works inside founder-led, family-owned, and PE-backed B2B firms (\$2M–\$15M) across winning, keeping, and growing customers.

fixyourrevenueengine.com · linkedin.com/in/jasonrigolli